

Print Content (completed master copy, English)

Page 1 — Cover

- Title: JAPAN RAIL TRIP PLANNER
- Subtitle: Shinkansen, Rail Passes & City-to-City Routes
- Footer line: This planner belongs to: _____

Page 2 — Contents

Page	Section
3	How to Use This Planner
4	Rail Pass Decision Worksheet
5	Rail Basics & Glossary
6	Multi-City Route Map Planner
7	City-to-City Travel Log
8	Model Route A: Golden Route
9	Model Route B: Wide Japan Loop
10	Model Route C: Slow North Loop
11	Reserved Seat & Booking Tracker
12	Station Transfer Notes
13-16	Day-by-Day Plan
17	Rail Budget Tracker
18	Packing Notes for Train Travel
19	Useful Station Phrases
20	Journey Reflection

Page 3 — How to Use This Planner

- Step 1: List the cities you want to visit and roughly how many nights in each.
- Step 2: Use the Rail Pass Decision Worksheet to compare a nationwide pass, a regional pass, or single tickets.
- Step 3: Map your route in order, then log each train leg in the Travel Log.
- Step 4: Reserve seats for long or busy legs early and record them in the Booking Tracker.
- Tip: Keep travel days light — moving between distant cities can eat a half day.

Page 4 — Rail Pass Decision Worksheet

Question	Your Answer
How many travel days (city-to-city) total?	_____
Longest single trip (e.g. east-west)?	_____
Do you stay mostly in one region? (Y/N)	_____
Pass type considered (nationwide / regional / none)	_____
Estimated single-ticket cost (add legs below)	_____
Estimated pass cost	_____
Which is cheaper / simpler?	_____

Single-ticket cost estimate:

Leg	One-way fare	Round?	Subtotal
____ → ____			
____ → ____			
____ → ____			
____ → ____			
		Total	

> Note: Pass coverage and prices change. Confirm which trains and regions each pass includes before buying.

Page 5 — Rail Basics & Glossary

- Shinkansen: high-speed bullet train network linking major cities.
- Limited Express: fast intercity train, slower than shinkansen, often regional.
- Local / Rapid: short-distance trains, no reservation needed.
- Reserved seat: assigned seat, recommended on busy dates.
- Non-reserved seat: first-come seating in set cars.
- IC card: rechargeable tap card for local trains, subways, and buses.
- Green car: premium carriage with wider seats.
- Tip: Some fastest trains may not be covered by every pass — check before boarding.

Page 6 — Multi-City Route Map Planner

List your cities in travel order and how you connect them.

#	City / Base	Nights	Arrive by	Next leg connects to
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

Sketch box (draw your loop and arrows):

[_____]

[_____]

[_____]

Page 7 — City-to-City Travel Log

[illegible]

Page 8 — Model Route A: Golden Route (first-timer favorite)

A classic east-west line linking the biggest cities, easy by shinkansen.

Day	Base	Idea
1-3	Tokyo	City sights, day trip option
4	Transit	Tokyo → Kyoto by shinkansen
4-6	Kyoto	Temples, gardens, old streets
7	Osaka	Food and nightlife (short hop from Kyoto)
8	Flex	Day trip or return leg

- Fill in your own dates: Start ____ / End ____
- Pace check (1=relaxed, 5=packed): ____

Page 9 — Model Route B: Wide Japan Loop

A longer loop reaching further west, good value if you ride many legs.

Day	Base	Idea
1-2	Tokyo	Arrival, city
3-4	Kyoto	Culture
5	Osaka	Food
6	Hiroshima	History & nearby island
7	Return / Fukuoka extension	Long shinkansen leg

• Notes: _____

Page 10 — Model Route C: Slow North Loop

A quieter route for repeat visitors who want fewer crowds and scenery.

Day	Base	Idea
1-2	Tokyo	Arrival
3	Toyama / Hokuriku coast	Mountains & sea
4	Kanazawa	Gardens & crafts
5	Return via shinkansen	Scenic leg

- Notes: _____

Page 11 — Reserved Seat & Booking Tracker

Date	Train / route	Seat / car	Confirmation #	Booked via	☒
					☒
					☒
					☒
					☒
					☒

- Reminder: Reserve early for weekends, holidays, and peak travel seasons.

Page 12 — Station Transfer Notes

Big stations can be large — plan your changes.

Station	Arrive line/platform	Next line/platform	Walk time	Notes
---------	-------------------------	--------------------	-----------	-------

- Buffer rule: leave at least 10-15 min for unfamiliar transfers.

Page 13 — Day-by-Day Plan (Day _____)

- City / base: _____
- Morning: _____
- Afternoon: _____
- Evening: _____
- Train legs today: _____
- Meals: _____
- Budget today: _____

Page 14 — Day-by-Day Plan (Day _____)

- City / base: _____
- Morning: _____
- Afternoon: _____
- Evening: _____
- Train legs today: _____
- Meals: _____
- Budget today: _____

Page 15 — Day-by-Day Plan (Day ____)

- City / base: _____
- Morning: _____
- Afternoon: _____
- Evening: _____
- Train legs today: _____
- Meals: _____
- Budget today: _____

Page 16 — Day-by-Day Plan (Day _____)

- City / base: _____
- Morning: _____
- Afternoon: _____
- Evening: _____
- Train legs today: _____
- Meals: _____
- Budget today: _____

Page 17 — Rail Budget Tracker

Item	Estimated	Actual
Rail pass		
Extra single tickets		
Seat reservations / upgrades		
IC card top-ups (local trains)		
Airport-to-city transfer		
Luggage forwarding (if used)		
Total		

- Saving idea: forward big bags between cities so you travel light on busy lines.

Page 18 — Packing Notes for Train Travel

Item	☒
Compact carry-on bag (fits overhead)	☒
Oversized-baggage plan / reservation	☒
IC card or transport card	☒
Offline maps & route screenshots	☒
Snacks / water for long legs	☒
Power bank	☒
Printed bookings & confirmations	☒

- Tip: Some lines require advance reservation for very large suitcases.

Page 19 — Useful Station Phrases

English	Japanese (romaji)
Where is the platform for ___?	___ no hōmu wa doko desu ka?
One reserved seat, please.	Shitei-seki o ichi-mai onegaishimasu.
Is this train going to ___?	Kono densha wa ___ ni ikimasu ka?
What time does it leave?	Nanji ni demasu ka?
Where do I transfer?	Doko de norikae desu ka?
Thank you.	Arigatō gozaimasu.

Page 20 — Journey Reflection

- Best train ride: _____
- Smoothest connection: _____
- What I'd route differently: _____
- Favorite city stop: _____
- Note for next trip: _____